

The Hive Bible

Founder Spec Blueprint

Why this document

This blueprint defines the complete product specification that will serve as the single source of truth for Hive. It is intended for engineers, designers and AI coding agents so the product can be built with minimal ambiguity.

Document Structure

1. Vision and Mission
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3. User Personas
4. Jobs To Be Done
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6. Complete WhatsApp Conversation Flows
7. AI System Prompt
8. Function Calling Specification
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10. Backend Architecture
11. API Documentation
12. Nomba Integration Guide
13. WhatsApp Integration
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15. Design System
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17. Sprint Plan
18. Engineering Tasks
19. Acceptance Criteria
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21. Product Roadmap
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Vision

Hive is the first AI employee for African SMEs. Merchants should never learn complex business software; they should simply chat with an AI that manages commerce on their behalf.

Product Philosophy

AI should perform work, not merely answer questions. WhatsApp is the primary interface. Dashboards are secondary. Every interaction should save merchants time.

Personas

Fashion vendor, food vendor, electronics seller, pharmacy, salon, POS agent, freelancer, customer, delivery partner and platform administrator.

Jobs To Be Done

Create a store, manage inventory, answer customers, collect payments, generate invoices, track revenue, recover inactive customers, market products and grow the business.

Conversation Library

Document every merchant and customer conversation including onboarding, product creation, payment collection, refunds, inventory updates, analytics requests, promotions and support.

AI Layer

Define the system prompt, personality, tool usage rules, memory strategy, function-calling contracts, safety rules and response style.

Engineering

Specify backend modules, database tables, APIs, queues, webhook processing, authentication, deployment and observability.

Nomba

Document payment links, collections, webhooks, transfers, virtual accounts, reconciliation and future subscription support.

Build Plan

Break the hackathon into daily milestones, assign ownership, define acceptance criteria and prepare a polished demo.

Long-Term Vision

This hackathon MVP is the first step toward Hive becoming the operating system for African commerce.